



CT-268 PROFESSIONAL ETHICS

LECTURE 1

INTRODUCTION

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WHAT DO YOU UNDERSTAND BY ... ?

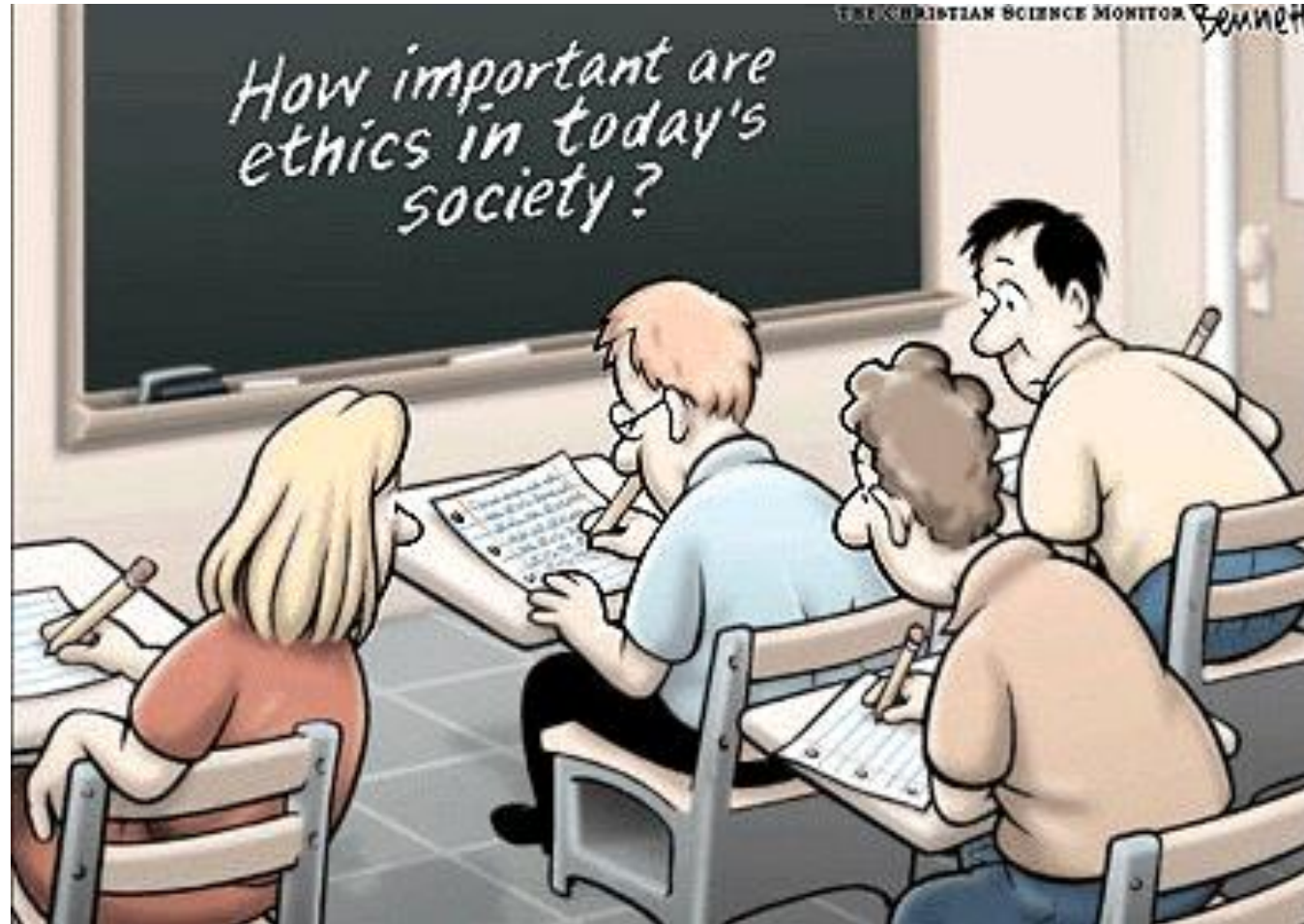
- Values
- Morals
- Ethics



WHAT DO YOU UNDERSTAND BY ... ?

- Values
 - Values explain important behavior and beliefs of a person or group.
 - Values are a person's principles or standards of behavior; one's judgment of what is important in life.
- Morals
 - Morals are then based on the belief and understanding of these values.
 - Morals are standards of behavior founded in beliefs (including religion) e.g. something is either good (righteous) or evil.
- Ethics
 - Ethics is the philosophy of how that morality guides individual and group behavior. The two are closely related, with morality being the foundation of ethics.
 - Ethics are standards of behavior founded upon learned conduct e.g. something is either right or wrong (legal or illegal).

ETHICS





PROFESSIONAL ETHICS

- Professional ethics is the set of standards adopted by professionals to the extent they view themselves acting as professionals.
- It is defined as specification of the ideal standards for a profession that is adopted by a professional group or organization that is intended to direct its members to assume their professional responsibilities.
- A set of ethics and public decorum is usually defined by the laws and regulations of every profession.



As Computing Professionals, can you name the
International Body?



COMPUTING ETHICS

- A branch of ethics that examines ethical problems aggravated, transformed, or created by computer technology.
- The analysis of the nature and social impact of computer technology and the corresponding formulation and justification of policies for the ethical use of such technology.
- Computer ethics identifies and analyzes the impacts of information technology on such social and human values as health, wealth, work, opportunity, freedom, democracy, knowledge, privacy, security, self-fulfillment, etc.
- Societies place trust in **professions** and the **members of professions**, such as **computer professionals**.





BUSINESS ETHICS

- Business ethics are the moral rules and values that guide how companies and workers make choices.
- They go past simple laws to shape fair, honest, and responsible behavior.
- Good ethics help businesses build trust with customers, keep a good name, and succeed over time.
- Its Core Principles include:
 - **Honesty:** Telling the truth in all sales, ads, and talks.
 - **Fairness:** Treating workers, buyers, and partners with equal and open respect.
 - **Accountability:** Accepting responsibility for actions and fixing mistakes.
 - **Transparency:** Sharing clear and open facts about how the business works.
 - **Environmental Care:** Protecting nature and reducing harm or waste.





BUSINESS AND PROFESSIONAL CONDUCT

- **Client & Employer Trust:** Keep proprietary business secrets safe while fulfilling work contracts honestly.
- **Product Quality:** Strive for high technical standards and test systems thoroughly before release.
- **Lifelong Learning:** Keep tech skills and knowledge of social impacts up to date.
- **Fair Collegiality:** Support fellow workers and give credit where it is due.



WHY STUDY PROFESSIONAL ETHICS?

- **Navigating Dilemmas:** Equips you with frameworks to resolve hard choices when rules conflict.
- **Building Trust:** Enhances credibility with clients, teams, and the public.
- **Ensuring Compliance:** Prevents costly legal infractions, fraud, and professional misconduct.
- **Fostering Accountability:** Encourages ownership of mistakes and responsible problem-solving.
- **Strengthening Leadership:** Inspires collaborative, respectful, and transparent workplace cultures.

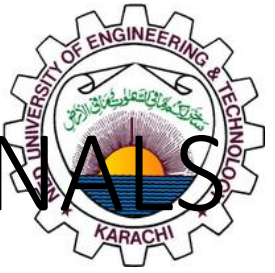
ETHICAL ISSUES FACED BY PROFESSIONALS



- Public Safety
- Bribery and Fraud
- Environmental Protection
- Fairness
- Honesty in Research and Testing
- Conflicts of Interest



... and SPECIALLY BY COMPUTING PROFESSIONALS



- **Data Privacy and Misuse**
 - **Surveillance and Tracking:** Collecting user data without clear consent.
 - **Data Breaches:** Failing to secure sensitive personal and financial records.
 - **Targeted Profiling:** Exploiting consumer behavior data for manipulation or intrusive ads.
- **Artificial Intelligence and Algorithms**
 - **Algorithmic Bias:** Building automated systems that perpetuate racial, gender, or socioeconomic discrimination.
 - **Deepfakes and Misinformation:** Creating synthetic media that spreads false narratives and ruins reputations.
 - **Job Displacement:** Automating human labor without considering economic impacts on workers.
- **Accountability and Security**
 - **Lack of Oversight:** Blurring lines of responsibility between third-party vendors and internal teams when systems fail.
 - **Hiding Software Flaws:** Releasing unsafe applications or medical software with known, dangerous bugs.
 - **Intellectual Property Violations:** Stealing proprietary source code or engaging in software piracy.



IN PROFESSIONAL PRACTICE...

- Make decisions – make the right choice
- Take action – do the right thing
- Personal integrity and self-respect
- Element of professional reputation
- HIGH ETHICS -> HIGH PROFITS



CONCLUSION

- Professional and business ethics for computing professionals guide safe, honest, and responsible technology use.
- Core frameworks like the ACM Code of Ethics and IEEE Software Engineering Code require experts to prioritize public safety, protect data privacy, respect intellectual property, and maintain professional competence.

